

Halo 5 in 2014

The next installment in the Halo series has been rumoured to have a 2015 launch date
<http://dgit.in/Halo2014>



Harvard dogecoin mining

The Harvard Odyssey supercomputer was found to be secretly mining Dogecoin
<http://dgit.in/HarwardDoge>

GPU Test

HOW WE TESTED

These cards were tested to rate them on three primary categories. The first is pure performance under which current AAA titles with high graphical requirements are run multiple times by varying the configuration to judge how the card performs as graphical load varies. A score of 30 FPS is the bare minimum average for an average gaming experience while the fabled 60 FPS gets more attention from gamers. Apart from games, the cards were also run through some synthetic benchmarks which are mentioned below. The rig on which these cards were tested was comprised of the following hardware:

Processor: Intel Core i7 4960X

Motherboard: ASRock X79 Extreme 9

RAM: 2x ADATA AX3U2133XW4 G10-2X (4x 4GB @ 2133MHz)

Boot drive: Seagate 600 240GB SSD

Cooler: Stock Intel liquid cooling solution

SMPS: CoolerMaster Silent Pro M850

Monitor: BenQ GW2450

Performance benchmarks

3DMark

Being an all round benchmarking software and due to the fact that it's considered as a standard by many organisations, the new 3DMark suite was used for the synthetic test. The Fire Strike test was used to judge each card's performance while also to validate the scores against users who've used a similar configuration.

FurMark

This is an OpenGL based benchmark that is capable of running a burn test on the GPU which is where we get our load temperatures from. Also the score obtained is considered towards the that card's performance parameter.

LuxMark

LuxMark is an OpenCL benchmark and helps judge a card's parallel processing capabilities. It basically uses the GPU to render a 3-dimensional scenario for about 120 seconds. This score is also added onto the performance parameter.

Bioshock Infinite

One of the highly talked AAA title released last year, Bioshock Infinite is moderately taxing on the graphics card. So it gives a decent FPS across all segments and especially helps discern performance difference in the lower segments.

Tomb Raider

Another AAA title, Tomb Raider features is much more taxing on graphics cards compared to Bioshock Infinite and is used to discern performance differences in the middle segment.

Sleeping Dogs

It has been quite a while since this game has been launched but it still manages to be more resource heavy than the previous two gaming benchmarks and has a mixture of day and night scenarios.

Hitman Absolution

This is the last game benchmark that we run and is so power hungry that even the flagship cards of the current series can't manage to get a decent FPS. The score mostly lies in the early to mid 20's while exceptionally powerful cards can push it past 30.

Build Quality

Each card is examined closely to check which materials are used in the construction of the body and shroud. Cooling technology which includes the type of heatsink and the materials used in the construction are also considered. Cards having a heatsink over the VRM and having extra reinforcement with as less dangling components are given a higher score. Extra features like dual bios, v-check points, better fans etc., are also considered towards build quality. The temperature at load is used to judge the cooling technology.

Value for money

The total performance score generated by a particular card is divided by the cost of the card to deduce the performance/rupee factor. Often this leads to the most cheapest card in the lot being picked as the card that offers the most value for your money. However, this parameter also helps decide between close competitions as cards with the same GPU often end up being very close in terms of performance. This is where the VFM comes into the picture and decides the winner.

all you want is something to enable your monitor, the second segment helps with gaming at full HD using a decent configuration. The last segment is for people who consider gaming a

priority. With these cards you are guaranteed to not need any upgrades for about two years if you prefer to game at 1080p using maximum configuration without bottlenecks.

Performance

Given the fact that most of our benchmarks are more suited towards mid-range and high end cards the low end cards would obviously struggle; with

single digit scores being the norm. However, breaking down the test into three segments provided a fair ground for all cards since they were then compared with similar performing SKUs.

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